

Cat Sudden Aggression Reintroduction Guide — Action Checklist

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IMMEDIATE SEPARATION

- ☐ **Immediate Separation:** Put each cat in their own room with food, water, litter box, and a familiar-smelling item, avoiding rooms next to each other to prevent stress from proximity.
- ☐ **Immediate Separation:** Check both cats carefully for injuries around the neck, face, and base of the tail, and schedule a vet visit if you find blood, swelling, or flinching.
- ☐ **Immediate Separation:** Observe which cat appears more frightened and withdrawn to determine who was likely the target versus the initiator of the aggression.
- ☐ **Immediate Separation:** Spend 15 minutes sitting quietly with each cat separately, speaking softly and watching for defensive body language including tight posture, dilated pupils, or a twitching tail tip.

MEDICAL ASSESSMENT

- ☐ **Medical Assessment:** Look for pre-fight personality changes in the aggressor like decreased interest in food, increased withdrawal, or unusual irritability that suggests pain-referral aggression.
- ☐ **Medical Assessment:** Determine if the aggression was disproportionate to the trigger, meaning a normal approach from the other cat set off an extreme reaction that doesn't fit the situation.
- ☐ **Medical Assessment:** Note whether the aggressor's behavior is inconsistent, being fine with you but hostile toward the other cat or behaving differently in different rooms.
- ☐ **Medical Assessment:** Schedule a veterinary workup as your priority if pain-referral patterns are present, because medical intervention takes precedence over behavioral reintroduction.

ROOT CAUSE MAPPING

- ☐ **Root Cause Mapping:** Reconstruct the three days before the fight by going day by day and noting any guests, furniture changes, new household items, or routine disruptions.

 - ☐ **Root Cause Mapping:** Write down any changes to your own schedule in the past week, including work hour changes, overnight absences, or increased visitor frequency.

 - ☐ **Root Cause Mapping:** Consider whether the fight was the final event in a stress cascade rather than a standalone incident, checking for accumulated low-level triggers you may have missed.

 - ☐ **Root Cause Mapping:** Document all environmental changes and cat behaviors you observe to identify the specific domino that fell last and triggered the fight.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.